Nhat (Johnny) Dao

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Education

University of Missouri - Kansas City | 3.8 GPA **Graduating Dec. 2027**
B.S. in Computer Science *Kansas City, MO*
- *Center of Excellence in Spatial Computing | Micro-Credential*
  - Used Python and R for geospatial analysis and Unity to apply AI/ML concepts in AR/VR.

Johnson County Community College **Dec. 2024**
A.A.S in Computer Information Systems *Overland Park, KS*

Experience

ASSET Research Lab Assistant | AI Cybersecurity **Mar. 2025 – Present**
University of Missouri - Kansas City *Kansas City, MO*
- Built a two-stage **Python harness** for detecting malicious AI-agent skills using **Typesafe Jev** to screen file chunks, then **Qwen 3.8** for reviewing uncertain cases through Ollama. Resulted in identifying up to **93% of malicious skills** out of set of 200 known-malicious skills out of 300 skill dataset.
- Reproduced two AI coding-agent security studies involving **hidden-image prompt injection** and multi-stage tool attacks, executing 100 isolated trials across frontier AI models.
- Co-authored a research paper analyzing **100K+ AI-agent extensions** across skills, MCP servers, and plugins, examining how reliably models and humans identify **malicious components** and how agent-mediated execution affects realized harm.
- Awarded a UMKC **SEARCH undergraduate research grant** to investigate data exfiltration risks in AI-agent skills, MCP servers, and plugins.

Projects

CyberPI (Hack Midwest 2026) | *Python, AWS Strands, Rekognition, TypeSafe Jev* **Oct. 2026**
- Built a Python internet search pipeline for an app that searches for a user's online profiles from a face snapshot. The pipeline uses Trace and Yandex/Bing reverse-image searching, and uses **Amazon Rekognition** for facial recognition.
- Used **AWS Strands** agents powered by Claude to scrape for search results and **TypeSafe Jev** to group accounts into profiles, then mapped related profiles to form link graph connections, assigning each profile with a trust value.

Windows Autobot | *Electron, PowerShell, CDP, Windows UI Automation* **May 2026**
- Built a Windows assistant that finds running Electron and Win32 apps, reads their UI state through **Chrome DevTools Protocol** or **UI Automation**, and runs predefined actions through successive model tool calls.
- Added agent settings for each app, window and tab selection, and tools to create, edit, and run saved automations. Used Electron context isolation and defined IPC interfaces.

Research Paper Audio Reader | *Tauri, React, TypeScript, Rust, Node.js* **Jul. 2026**
- Built a **Tauri/React** desktop app that reads research PDFs aloud using local text-to-speech. Added column-aware text extraction, sentence highlighting, and automatic scrolling.
- Integrated the Kokoro text-to-speech model through a local **Node.js** service. Added audio caching, click-to-read controls, and saved reading progress.

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: C++, Python, Swift, C, C#, Lua, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, SQL
Frameworks & Libraries: SwiftUI, React, Electron, .NET, Node.js, FastAPI, Django, pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib
Databases: SQLite, PostgreSQL
Developer Tools: Git, Bash, IntelliJ, Claude Code, OpenAI Codex

Leadership

Roonited Esports Club | *Vice President, University of Missouri - Kansas City* **Jan. 2026 – May 2026**
- Co-led UMKC's esports club as **vice president**, organized campus social events and represented the club in student media, and led its VALORANT team to a tournament **championship** as **in-game leader**.